

The Man You Bring In

Proposing a candidate

RESPONSIBILITIES

What you are actually signing when you put a man's name forward, what the ballot is for, and what the first twelve months should look like if you do it properly.

ON THE TABLE

A proposal form



Masonic Ballot Box 1740s — Catlemur
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HOW THE PAPER RUNS

0:00	Opening
1:00	What the form actually is
2:30	The three ancient tests
4:15	The ballot, and what it is for
5:45	What you have actually signed up to
7:45	The number that should worry us
8:45	Closing

THREE THINGS TO TAKE AWAY

- 1 You are not filling an application. You and your seconder are vouching for a man to this lodge.



THE MAN YOU BRING IN

- 2 The ballot is secret and absolute, and no brother need give a reason.
- 3 The ceremony is not where we lose men. We lose them in the eleven months afterwards, when nobody rings.

IF YOU ARE ASKED

Must the proposer know the candidate personally?

Yes, and so should the seconder. Two men vouching, not one man and a signature.

Can a candidate be refused without a reason?

Yes. The ballot is secret and absolute, and no member need justify his vote.

What is the minimum age?

Twenty-one under UGLE, or eighteen by dispensation.

Whose job is the first year?

Formally the Mentor's. In practice the proposer's, and the lodge's.

SOURCES

- UGLE Book of Constitutions — qualifications of candidates, proposal and ballot
- UGLE Mentoring Scheme — published guidance for lodge Mentors and proposers
- Your Provincial Membership Officer, on retention figures for this Province

Every paper is drawn from openly published masonic literature. Nothing here discloses the esoteric work of any degree; all of it is safe to deliver with visitors present, provided the visitors are brethren.

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